MIGRAINE CARE GUIDE

Simple daily habits to prevent and manage migraine

Shared by Dr. Sindhuja | Anesthesiologist, Interventional Pain & Regenerative Specialist

Migraine is more than "just a headache". It often comes with throbbing pain, nausea, and sensitivity to light and sound. The good news: small, steady lifestyle habits can reduce how often it strikes. Here is your quick guide.

1 Stay Hydrated

- Sip water regularly through the day
- Avoid long periods without fluids
- Drink more in hot weather or exercise
- Carry a water bottle with you

2 Don't Skip Meals

- Keep regular meal timings
- Avoid long gaps between meals
- Keep a healthy snack handy
- Do not start the day on an empty stomach

3 Maintain Good Sleep

- Fixed sleep and wake-up time
- Avoid frequently changing your schedule
- Give your body enough rest
- Switch off screens before bed

4 Know Your Personal Triggers

Keep a simple migraine diary and note down:

- What you ate
- Water intake
- Sleep duration
- Stress level
- Screen exposure
- Time headache started
- How long it lasted

Date	Food / Water	Sleep (hrs)	Stress (1-5)	Started / Lasted

Common triggers to watch for:

Dehydration	Skipped meals	Poor / irregular sleep
Stress & anxiety	Long screen time	Bright light / loud noise
Strong smells	Too much caffeine	Weather change
Hormonal changes (in women)		

5 What To Do During an Attack

Rest	Lie down in a quiet, dark room if light or sound worsens symptoms
Hydrate	Sip water slowly and stay hydrated
Medicine	Follow only the plan prescribed by your doctor
Avoid triggers	Stay away from your known personal triggers

GO TO EMERGENCY IMMEDIATELY IF YOU HAVE

- Sudden, very severe "worst ever" headache
- Weakness, numbness, or trouble speaking
- Fever with neck stiffness
- Sudden vision loss, confusion, or fainting
- Headache after a head injury

Helpful habits

- Practise relaxation: deep breathing, yoga, meditation
- Take screen breaks (every 20-30 minutes)
- Gentle regular exercise like walking
- Limit caffeine, and have it at fixed times

Try to avoid

- Skipping breakfast or lunch
- Late-night scrolling and irregular sleep
- Self-medicating with painkillers again and again
- Ignoring early warning signs (aura, nausea, light sensitivity)

6 When To See a Doctor

Seek medical evaluation if your migraines are:

- Becoming more frequent
- Becoming more severe
- Interfering with your daily activities
- Needing painkillers more than 2-3 days a week (overuse can worsen headaches)

Need personal advice? Consult the doctor.

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Important: Migraine triggers differ from person to person. This guide is for general education and does not replace a medical consultation.